



New Eyes on the Road

SUDARSHAN VENU—known for expanding the reins of Chennai-based TVS Motor Company to Asia, Africa and Europe—has been given a new role. He's the new MD. His father, Venu Srinivasan, is now the Chairman Emeritus, while sister Lakshmi has become MD

of Sundaram-Clayton, the group's component manufacturing firm. With the two-wheeler industry yet to recover fully to pre-Covid levels, and challenges rising from start-ups and newer electric vehicle players, it looks like Venu's first few years will be packed with action.

—PRERNA LIDHOO



INSURING INSURERS

DEBASISH PANDA, Chairman of the Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India, has raised the exposure limit by insurance companies in the BFSI sector to 30 per cent. The earlier limit was 25 per cent. Currently, 70-75 per cent of insurers' investments are in low-risk instruments such as government securities, state government bonds and infrastructure bonds. The increased headroom would give them flexibility to invest in different assets.

—TEENA JAIN KAUSHAL

FOR FAIR PLAY

Tech billionaire **Nandan Nilekani** is spearheading the development of an open technology network that will empower Indian small merchants in their fight against e-commerce giants Amazon and Walmart-owned Flipkart. This freely accessible platform—Open Network for Digital Commerce (ONDC)—will allow India's small merchants to reach potential consumers without depending on the marketplaces, which dominate the online retail market via preferential treatment and deep discounting.

—BINU PAUL



Nandan Nilekani is leading the development of the freely accessible Open Network for Digital Commerce or ONDC platform, which will help small merchants in India reach potential customers without depending on marketplaces



Dial C For...

COAL, CHIPS or communications, minister **Ashwini Vaishnaw** is the Modi government's go-to person for solutions. As India experiences one of its worst summers, he has been working to rush coal supplies to 173 power plants, selecting companies to turn the country into a global semiconductor hub, and preparing for 5G spectrum allocations, scheduled in June.

—MANISH PANT

CHEQUE THAT



Two cheques with a cumulative value of \$2.4 billion have firmly established **James Murdoch** and **Uday Shankar** on the Indian M&E landscape. Routed through Bodhi Tree Systems, the duo, who oversaw the growth of Star India before the global sale to Disney in 2018, now have a play in Indian television broadcasting and digital through a \$1.78-billion equity infusion into Viacom18, a venture where Reliance Industries will be the largest shareholder. The other deal is worth \$600 million in Allen Career Institute, a test prep business. It is only fair to say there will be more to follow.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN



The Foreign Hand

USUALLY, XIAOMI is in the news for bumper sales figures, but now the hullabaloo is about the ED seizing more than ₹5,500 crore worth assets of the company allegedly for making illegal remittances to foreign entities and showing them as royalty payments since 2015. Its Global Vice President **Manu Kumar Jain** was also summoned by the ED to get details. Xiaomi has claimed it is "fully compliant with all the regulations".

—PRERNA LIDHOO